

Col. Rajeev Mannali: A Transformational Leader in Healthcare



Col. Rajeev
CEO of Sree Uthradam Thirunal
(SUT) Super Specialty Hospital

Col. Rajeev Mannali's journey from the battlefields of the Indian Army to revolutionizing healthcare leadership is a testament to resilience, strategy, and an unwavering commitment to service. A decorated military veteran, Col. Mannali dedicated over 33 years to the armed forces, excelling in high-stakes leadership roles, including commanding the 13 Armored Regiment during the Kargil War and serving as Director (Foreign Division) in Military Intelligence. His ability to lead under pressure and execute strategic operations has seamlessly transitioned into his second innings—steering healthcare institutions to excellence.

Post-retirement in 2009, Col. Mannali embarked on an inspiring journey in the healthcare sector. As Managing Director and CEO of Indo American Hospital, Vaikom, he laid the foundation for transformative leadership in the industry. His tenure at Sree Narayani Hospital & Research Centre and Christian Medical College (CMC) Vellore's

Chittoor Complex showcased his ability to drive operational efficiency, patient-centric care, and institutional growth. Notably, as Executive Director of Sree Narayana Institute of Medical Sciences (SNIMS), he fostered academic excellence and strengthened collaborations with medical authorities.

Taking the reins as CEO of Sree Uthradam Thirunal (SUT) Super Specialty Hospital, Pattom, Trivandrum in 2018, Col. Mannali turned around the institution within two and a half years. His leadership propelled SUT into a new realm of operational efficiency, medical advancements, and strategic expansion. By implementing a comprehensive restructuring plan, he streamlined hospital operations, enhanced patient care services, and introduced innovative management protocols that improved overall healthcare delivery. Under his leadership, SUT Hospital saw a remarkable increase in patient inflow, expansion of specialty departments, and stronger collaborations with national and international healthcare bodies.

Col. Mannali's ability to drive impactful change has been rooted in his deep understanding of organizational dynamics and his relentless pursuit of quality. He has been instrumental in fostering a culture of continuous improvement, aligning his institutions with national and international accreditation standards. His role as a founding member of ANBAI, AHPI, CAHO, and the Vaikom Management Association underscores his commitment to shaping the broader healthcare landscape in India. His thought leadership has influenced policy frameworks, accreditation processes, and quality improvement initiatives across the industry.

Beyond hospital management, Col. Mannali has contributed significantly to the intersection of healthcare and social development. During his tenure at Bahuleyan Charitable Foundation, he spearheaded initiatives that extended beyond clinical care—establishing women's self-help groups, empowering youth through skill development programs, and ensuring healthcare accessibility for marginalized communities. His leadership transformed the institution into a

model of sustainable healthcare and community engagement, earning him widespread recognition. Col. Mannali's contributions to the healthcare industry have not gone unnoticed. He has received multiple awards, including the prestigious 'CEO of the Year' at the National Awards for Excellence in Healthcare. His ability to lead with vision, his strategic acumen, and his dedication to creating a lasting impact have positioned him as one of India's most influential healthcare executives. Recognized for his excellence in leadership, he has been honored by governmental and non-governmental agencies alike, further cementing his legacy as a transformative force in the industry.

A prolific writer and speaker, Col. Mannali has been actively sharing his expertise through articles, keynote addresses, and panel discussions at national and international forums. His insights on hospital management, leadership, and quality improvement continue to inspire the next generation of healthcare professionals. His extensive collection of articles and talks, available on www.colrajeevmannali.com, serves as a valuable resource for those seeking guidance on healthcare transformation and institutional excellence.

Col. Rajeev Mannali's legacy is a powerful reminder that leadership is not just about managing institutions but about inspiring change, fostering innovation, and improving lives. His extraordinary journey—from commanding troops on the battlefield to leading healthcare institutions to new heights—exemplifies the power of adaptability, resilience, and purpose-driven leadership. Beyond operational excellence, he has consistently prioritized patient-centered care, ensuring that hospitals under his leadership foster a culture of empathy, accessibility, and trust. His emphasis on patient approachability has strengthened doctor-patient relationships, enhanced service delivery, and reinforced the belief that quality healthcare must always be humane and inclusive. As he continues to shape the future of healthcare in India, his contributions stand as a benchmark for excellence, setting the standard for visionary leadership in the sector.